

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

INSTRUCTIONS

1. This paper contains 100 questions. Each question has four alternatives.
2. Each correct response carries 2 marks; one-third of the marks assigned to a question (shown as 0.66) is deducted for an incorrect response; an unattempted question carries zero.
3. Current-affairs content is limited to information available on or before 2026-09-10.

Q1. Article 74 control Consider the following statements: 1. The President may require ministerial advice to be reconsidered once. 2. After reconsideration, the President may permanently reject the advice. 3. Article 74(2) bars inquiry into the advice but does not necessarily bar review of the resulting action. Which is correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 2 and 3 only

Q2. With reference to Articles 36 and 37, consider the following statements: 1. "State" in Part IV has the same meaning as in Part III. 2. Every Directive Principle creates an enforceable claim once Parliament has not acted for a reasonable period. 3. Article 37 combines non-enforceability with a duty on the State in making laws. Which statements are correct?

A. 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q3. Consider the following: 1. Article 49 protects nationally important monuments/places/objects declared by or under Parliamentary law. 2. Article 50 directs separation of judiciary from executive in State public services. 3. Article 51 encourages settlement of international disputes by arbitration. Which are correct?

A. 1 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q4. Consider the following amendment changes: 1. 42nd - Articles 39A, 43A and 48A 2. 44th - Article 38(2) 3. 86th - Article 21A and recast Article 45 4. 97th - Article 43B Which is the correct assessment?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 4 only	D. All four are correctly matched

Q5. Which matching is correct? 1. Article 43 - living wage and cottage industries 2. Article 43A - workers' participation in management 3. Article 43B - voluntary, autonomous, democratic and professionally managed co-operatives

A. 1, 2 and 3	B. 1 only
C. 1 and 3 only	D. 2 and 3 only

Q6. With reference to Article 245, consider the following statements: 1. Parliament may make laws for the whole or any part of India. 2. A parliamentary law is not invalid merely because it has extra-territorial operation. 3. A State law can never affect a person or transaction outside the State. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 1 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q7. Consider the following pairs: 1. Article 51A(e) - harmony, common brotherhood and dignity of women 2. Article 51A(g) - environment and compassion for living creatures 3. Article 51A(h) - scientific temper, humanism, inquiry and reform 4. Article 51A(b) - defence of the country and national service Which pairs are correctly matched?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 2, 3 and 4 only
C. 1, 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q8. Which statement about the current Article 31C is correct?

A. It protects every law implementing any Directive Principle from every Fundamental Right.	B. It was wholly erased when the 42nd Amendment extension was struck down.
C. It prevents courts from examining whether a law genuinely implements Article 39(b) or (c).	D. It protects genuine Article 39(b)/(c) laws against Articles 14 and 19, while judicial review of the nexus and basic structure remains.

Q9. Consider the following statements: 1. Article 270 concerns distribution of specified Union taxes between Union and States. 2. Article 271 permits a Union-purpose surcharge whose whole proceeds form part of the Consolidated Fund of India. 3. Article 271 applies without qualification to GST under Article 246A. 4. Specific-purpose parliamentary cesses are excluded from the divisible pool under Article 270. Which are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 3 and 4 only

Q10. Consider the following statements on Article 252: 1. Resolutions of two or more State legislatures initiate the route. 2. The law automatically applies to all States. 3. Another State may later adopt the law. 4. A participating State may amend the law by its own legislation. Which are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 4 only	D. 1, 3 and 4 only

Q11. Article 214 and common courts Which statement is constitutionally correct?

A. Every Union Territory must have an independent High Court.	B. Article 232 currently creates circuit benches.
C. Article 214's State-wise default operates with Article 231's power to establish a common High Court.	D. A common High Court merges the participating States' judicial services.

Q12. Which statement correctly distinguishes Article 40 and the 74th Amendment?

A. The 74th Amendment repealed Article 40.	B. Article 40 expressly directs creation of Municipalities.
C. Article 40 applies only to Parliament and not States.	D. Article 40 expressly concerns village panchayats; Municipalities are separately constitutionalised in Part IXA.

Q13. Consider the following statements about India's Countercyclical Capital Buffer (CCyB): 1. RBI has a framework under which the buffer can be activated with systemic conditions. 2. The cited Basel III Master Circular of 1 April 2025 reported it as not activated. 3. It permanently replaces the Capital Conservation Buffer. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q14. Consider the following general provisioning pairs under the RBI directions updated 1 July 2026: 1. Substandard asset - 15 per cent 2. Unsecured substandard exposure - 25 per cent 3. Loss asset retained in books - 100 per cent How many pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one	B. All three
C. Only two	D. None

Q15. Which statement best explains economic incidence of a mandi fee?

A. The farmer necessarily bears exactly the stated rate.	B. The fee is always identical to commission.
C. The statutory payer may shift some burden through the bid, so legal liability and economic incidence can differ.	D. The fee is a central MSP deduction fixed nationwide.

Q16. Under RBI's NDS-OM Directions dated 7 February 2025 and updated 27 April 2026, consider: 1. Direct access settles in the participant's own SGL account. 2. Indirect access uses another entity that assumes settlement responsibility. 3. Stock Broker Connect can provide access to individual demat clients. How many statements are correct?

A. Only one	B. Only two
C. None	D. All three

Q17. Consider the following statements: 1. QIP is undertaken by a listed issuer. 2. QIP places eligible securities with Qualified Institutional Buyers. 3. Every private placement is a QIP. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q18. Consider the following statements about agricultural NPA recognition: 1. A short-duration crop advance becomes NPA when overdue for two crop seasons. 2. A long-duration crop advance becomes NPA when overdue for one crop season. 3. A fall in crop prices by itself classifies every farm advance as NPA. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q19. Consider the following statements about a covered Basic Savings Bank Deposit account under RBI's amendment effective 1 April 2026: 1. No minimum balance is required for the prescribed basic facilities. 2. At least four withdrawals a month are free under the listed basic service. 3. Every holder receives an automatic Rs 10,000 loan. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q20. Consider the following pairs under the RBI Certificate of Deposit Directions dated 4 June 2021: 1. Minimum denomination - Rs 5 lakh 2. Issuance tenor for a bank CD - seven days to one year 3. Primary issue settlement - T+1 How many pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one	B. Only two
C. None	D. All three

Q21. Consider the following regulatory map: 1. SEBI - domestic listed securities, mutual funds and AIFs 2. RBI - specified OTC interest-rate and foreign-exchange derivatives 3. PFRDA - National Pension System 4. IFSCA - financial products and institutions in an IFSC Which option is correct?

A. 1, 2, 3 and 4	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 1, 3 and 4 only	D. 2, 3 and 4 only

Q22. Which statement about preference shares is correct? 1. They carry preferential dividend and capital-repayment rights over ordinary equity. 2. They are legally share capital. 3. They always rank ahead of secured creditors.

A. 1 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q23. Which statement best defines MSP?

A. It is a statutory monthly income paid to every farmer.	B. It is FCI's total economic cost.
C. It is a pre-season administered price signal for specified crops, not automatic universal purchase.	D. It is the retail price charged at every fair-price shop.

Q24. Consider the following statements about Primary Dealers: 1. They support government-security auctions through bidding or underwriting obligations. 2. They support secondary-market liquidity through market making. 3. They guarantee that every G-Sec investor avoids market loss. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q25. Consider the following statements: 1. Standard weights and scales support the inference of regular measurement in exchange. 2. Their use proves that Harappans used minted coinage. 3. Weights can be discussed with seals and craft production as parts of an integrated economy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q26. With reference to Harappan chronology, consider the following statements: 1. The Mature Harappan phase is conventionally placed c. 2600-1900 BCE. 2. The Early Harappan phase represents regional and proto-urban development. 3. The Late Harappan phase is best treated as an interval without settlement continuity. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 2 and 3 only

Q27. Consider the following site-feature pairs: 1. Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath 2. Kalibangan - ploughed-field evidence 3. Chanhudaro - specialised craft production How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

A. Only two	B. Only one
C. All three	D. None

Q28. Consider the following statements about social inference: 1. Variation in house size may suggest unequal access to resources. 2. House size alone proves a fixed caste system. 3. Burial and household evidence require context and comparison before social conclusions are drawn. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3	B. 1 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1 and 3 only

Q29. With reference to India on the Eve of the Medieval Age & Arab-Turkish Contacts, consider the following statements: 1. Satish Chandra stresses that Arab traders revived and strengthened India's sea trade with West Asia and other countries after overland routes had been affected. 2. Arab traders settled in Malabar; the Rashtrakuta rulers welcomed them and permitted mosques for worship. 3. Arab conquest of Sind immediately led to the Delhi Sultanate. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q30. With reference to The Ghaznavids & the Ghurian Invasions, consider the following statements: 1. The conventional textbook count assigns Mahmud seventeen Indian expeditions, but the counting of separate operations is not uniform; the secure point is his repeated raiding between 1000 and 1027. 2. His early wars were against the Hindu Shahis of Peshawar/Punjab; Jayapala and Anandapala offered prolonged resistance. 3. Jaichandra's absence at Tarain is proved only by the Sanyogita legend. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q31. With reference to Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate: The Slave (Mamluk) Dynasty, consider the following statements: 1. Qutbuddin Aibak was Muizzuddin's Turkish slave and an important commander after Tarain; in 1206 he ruled from Lahore and severed links with Ghazni. 2. Aibak's brief reign mattered because it prevented Delhi from being drawn into Central Asian politics and allowed the Sultanate to develop in India. 3. The Mongols crossed and conquered Delhi under Ilutunish. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q32. With reference to The Khaljis: Alauddin Khalji & Market Reforms, consider the following statements: 1. Alauddin faced repeated Mongol invasions of Delhi, which forced him to raise and pay a large standing army. 2. Cheap grain supply: land revenue in the doab (Meerut to Kara) was taken directly by the state (no iqta assignment), assessed at half (50%) of the produce. It was calculated in kind and generally demanded in cash, while areas near Delhi also supplied a portion in kind for royal stores. 3. The reforms applied across the whole empire. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q33. With reference to The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s), consider the following statements: 1. Aurangzeb's death in 1707 was followed by wars of succession and a rapid weakening of central authority; weak successors could not hold the vast empire together. 2. Bahadur Shah I (1707-12) followed a policy of compromise with Marathas, Rajputs and Sikhs, but reversed nothing fundamental; after him a series of weak rulers depended on powerful nobles. 3. Nadir Shah established Persian rule in India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q34. With reference to Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century, consider the following statements: 1. After Mughal decline, power shifted to regional states: Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad, Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Mysore, Rajput states

and Kerala/Travancore. 2. Bipin Chandra groups these states into successor states, new/rebel states, and independent kingdoms. 3. Marathas were a single centralised state under the Peshwa. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q35. With reference to The Beginnings of European Settlements, consider the following statements: 1. The Portuguese arrived first by sea when Vasco da Gama reached Calicut in 1498. 2. Portuguese power rested on naval control, fortified ports, the cartaz pass system and the Estado da India centred on Goa. 3. The Dutch were the main political rivals of the English in 18th-century India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q36. With reference to The British Conquest of Bengal (Plassey & Buxar), consider the following statements: 1. Bengal was one of the richest Mughal provinces, with fertile agriculture, textile production and active trade. 2. Murshid Quli Khan, Alivardi Khan and Siraj-ud-Daula made Bengal autonomous in practice while still linked to Mughal legitimacy. 3. The Black Hole episode alone caused the conflict. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q37. With reference to British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs), consider the following statements: 1. After Bengal, the Company used revenue, armies and alliances to defeat Mysore, Marathas and Sikhs. 2. Mysore under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan was a major southern opponent because it tried to modernise its army and resist Company control. 3. Awadh was annexed by Doctrine of Lapse. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q38. With reference to Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858, consider the following statements: 1. After Plassey (1757) and Buxar (1764), the East India Company was no longer only a trading body; with the Diwani of Bengal (1765) it controlled revenue and had to be regulated as a political power. 2. The early constitutional acts were Parliament's response to Company misrule, financial crisis and the need to make a private corporation answerable for governing Indian territories. 3. Charter Act 1853 by itself instantly created the competitive examination. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q39. Which stupa part-function pair is correctly matched?

A. Harmika - ground-level ambulatory path	B. Vedika - relic deposited inside the mound
C. Torana - ceremonial gateway carrying narrative or decorative emphasis	D. Chattras - stone railing around the lower terrace

Q40. Which statement best explains why temples matter beyond ritual?

A. Temples were only spaces of worship and cannot reveal political or social history.	B. Temples matter because they collapse all evidence into religion alone.
C. Temples can replace every other source and should be treated as full social censuses.	D. Temples record ritual, patronage, economic support, craft organisation, festivals and selected social representation in one durable institution.

Q41. Which statement best explains Vijayanagara temple planning?

A. Its temple complexes emphasize chariot streets, pillared mandapas and monumental gateways within a capital-wide sacred-royal landscape.	B. Vijayanagara architecture is entirely identical to Hoysala stellate soapstone temples.
C. Its main monuments are all rock-cut caves of the Mauryan age.	D. The tradition rejected all earlier South Indian influences.

Q42. Which monument-feature pair is correctly matched?

A. Virupaksha, Hampi - queen Lokmahadevi's 8th-century Chalukya victory temple	B. Vitthala, Hampi - stone chariot and musical-pillar fame within a Vijayanagara temple complex
C. Mahanavami Dibba - principal sanctum of the Virupaksha temple	D. Lotus Mahal - granite Nagara shikhara of a Chandella shrine

Q43. Which statement uses material as a chronology marker most carefully?

A. All Mughal phases used the same material logic, so chronology cannot be inferred from surface treatment.	B. White marble is a safe marker of every pre-Mughal building.
C. Akbar is associated with red sandstone scale, Jahangir-Nur Jahan with the white-marble turn, and Shah Jahan with marble refinement across tomb, fort and mosque.	D. Tughlaq architecture is best dated through pietra dura alone.

Q44. Which statement best explains why cinema belongs in the art-and-culture syllabus?

A. Cinema is only a branch of theatre because both use acting.	B. Cinema belongs only to Economy because tickets are sold in markets.
C. Cinema can be studied only through award lists.	D. Cinema combines narrative, performance, moving image, sound and editing, then adds reproducibility and mass circulation as a modern art form.

Q45. With reference to The Earth and the Universe, consider the following statements: 1. Earth's geometric approximation = oblate spheroid; geoid = gravity-defined mean-sea-level surface. 2. International Date Line 180 meridian. 3. P-waves cannot travel through liquids. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q46. With reference to The Earths Crust Rocks, consider the following statements: 1. Plutonic (intrusive) rocks cool slowly deep in the crust -> large, easily recognised crystals (granite); exposed later by denudation. 2. Volcanic (extrusive) rocks pour out as lava and solidify fast -> tiny crystals; basalt forms lava sheets/plateaux (Deccan, Columbia-Snake, Iceland). 3. Source rock of every metamorphic rock is obvious. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q47. With reference to Vulcanism and Earthquakes, consider the following statements: 1. Shield (lava dome) volcanoes form from fluid basic (basaltic) lava that spreads far -> gentle slopes and wide lava sheets. 2. Acid lava cones form from viscous lava that cannot flow far -> steep-sided cones. 3. Any volcano without a recorded historic eruption is extinct. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q48. With reference to Weathering, Mass Movement & Groundwater, consider the following statements: 1. Exfoliation: outer rock heats and peels off in thin layers like an onion; angular debris collects as scree at cliff foot. 2. Frost action: water expands by about 9% on freezing and can prise apart jointed, saturated rock. 3. Chemical weathering is strongest in cold dry climates. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q49. With reference to Landforms by Running Water, consider the following statements: 1. Upper course: swift descent, rapid down-cutting -> deep, narrow V-shaped valley; hard-rock bands give rapids and waterfalls; spurs interlock. 2. Middle course: gradient eases; vertical corrasion nearly ceases, lateral corrasion widens the valley; the river swings in meanders and cuts river cliffs. 3. V-shaped valleys and U-shaped valleys are both made by rivers. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q50. With reference to Landforms of Glaciation, consider the following statements: 1. Cirque (corrie/cwm): plucking on the back-wall + abrasion of the floor deepen a horse-shoe basin; a small lake in it is a tarn. 2. Arete = sharp ridge separating two cirques ('fish-bone'); where three or more cirques meet, a pyramidal horn forms (classic: Matterhorn). 3. The Ganga

rises at Gangotri town. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q51. With reference to Arid Desert Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Deflation lowers the land into deflation hollows by blowing away loose sand/dust; a lag of pebbles left behind forms a desert pavement. 2. Abrasion and deflation help sculpt zeugens (tabular, resistant cap rock over a narrower softer pedestal), pedestal/mushroom rocks and yardangs (streamlined ridges parallel to prevailing wind). 3. A yardang's long axis is perpendicular to the wind. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q52. With reference to Limestone and Karst Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Carbonation/solution of calcium carbonate is the dominant process; karst is dry at the surface and lacks a well-integrated drainage system (Majid). 2. Swallow holes/ponors are points where surface water sinks. Doline and sinkhole are overlapping terms for closed karst depressions; coalesced depressions may form uvalas, while poljes are much larger, structurally influenced, flat-floored basins. 3. Karst aquifers are well protected from contamination. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q53. With reference to Lakes: Formation & Types, consider the following statements: 1. Lake = water body in a land hollow/depression. 2. Major origins: tectonic, glacial, volcanic/crater, erosional, depositional and man-made. 3. Caspian Sea is an ocean/sea because of its name. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q54. With reference to Coastal Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Erosional sequence: cave -> arch -> stack -> stump. 2. Wave-cut platform widens as the cliff retreats. 3. Emergent and submergent coasts are wave-energy classes. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q55. With reference to Islands & Coral Reefs, consider the following statements: 1. Island types: continental, oceanic/volcanic and coral. 2. Coral polyps build limestone skeletons; zooxanthellae are symbiotic algae. 3. Corals thrive in cold, deep, muddy water. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q56. With reference to The Oceans: Currents, Tides & Salinity, consider the following statements: 1. Wind is the dominant driver of surface currents; density drives deep currents. 2. Warm current = poleward; cold current = equatorward. 3. Gyres rotate the same way in both hemispheres. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q57. With reference to Ecosystem Structure and Function, consider the following statements: 1. Producers are the sole entry point of energy into an ecosystem; energy flow is unidirectional and matter/nutrient flow is cyclic. 2. A food web is a network of interconnected food chains, giving greater ecosystem stability than a single linear chain. 3. A food chain and a food web are interchangeable terms. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q58. With reference to Biogeochemical Cycles and Ecological Pyramids, consider the following statements: 1. Carbon, nitrogen, oxygen and water are gaseous (atmosphere/ocean-reservoir) cycles; phosphorus, sulphur and calcium are sedimentary (crust-reservoir) cycles. 2. Biological nitrogen fixation is chiefly carried out by bacteria (free-living, e.g. Azotobacter, and symbiotic, e.g. Rhizobium in legume root nodules). 3. A single ecosystem always shows the same

pyramid shape for numbers, biomass and energy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q59. With reference to Ecological Succession and Biomes, consider the following statements: 1. Primary succession starts with no soil (bare rock/new land); secondary succession starts on existing soil after disturbance and is faster. 2. Lichens are classic pioneer species in primary succession on rock; they aid rock weathering and initial soil formation. 3. Primary and secondary succession happen at the same speed. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q60. With reference to Biodiversity Levels and Hotspots, consider the following statements: 1. Biodiversity has three levels: genetic, species and ecosystem diversity. 2. A hotspot must meet both Conservation International criteria - endemic vascular plant threshold and habitat-loss threshold - not just have "many species." 3. Hotspot status is a legally binding Indian conservation designation like a National Park. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q61. With reference to IUCN Red List and Endemism, consider the following statements: 1. The Red List category order (from least to most at risk) is: Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild, Extinct. 2. "Threatened" collectively means Vulnerable + Endangered + Critically Endangered. 3. A species' Red List category and its Wildlife Protection Act Schedule are always identical. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q62. With reference to Protected Area Network India, consider the following statements: 1. The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 provides four main protected-area categories: National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve. 2. National Parks have the strictest regime; private rights/grazing are not normally permitted unless specifically allowed. 3. A Tiger Reserve is a distinct fifth legal category alongside NP/WLS/Conservation Reserve/Community Reserve. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q63. With reference to Biosphere Reserves and Ramsar Sites, consider the following statements: 1. Biosphere Reserves are zoned into core, buffer and transition zones under the UNESCO MAB Programme model. 2. Not every Indian Biosphere Reserve is internationally UNESCO-recognised; recognition requires meeting MAB Programme criteria and formal inclusion in the World Network. 3. A Biosphere Reserve and a Ramsar Site are the same type of designation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q64. With reference to Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules, consider the following statements: 1. The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 is India's principal wildlife-protection statute. 2. Schedule I provides the highest/most stringent protection level under the Act. 3. Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q65. With reference to CITES and Wildlife Trade, consider the following statements: 1. CITES has three Appendices: I (trade generally prohibited), II (trade regulated via permits) and III (country-specific protection needing a certificate of origin). 2. CITES regulates international trade specifically, not domestic hunting/habitat protection directly - those remain matters of each country's domestic law. 3. Appendix I allows regulated commercial trade with permits like Appendix II. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
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C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3
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Q66. With reference to CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species, consider the following statements: 1. CMS (Bonn Convention, 1979) is administered under UNEP and focuses specifically on migratory species conservation across their entire range. 2. CMS has two main Appendices: Appendix I (strict protection) and Appendix II (cooperation encouraged through specific Agreements/MOUs). 3. CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q67. With reference to Forest Types and Forest Rights Act, consider the following statements: 1. India's major forest types (by the Champion-Seth-style classification) include tropical wet evergreen, tropical moist/dry deciduous, tropical thorn, and montane/alpine types. 2. Tropical moist and dry deciduous forests together cover the largest share of India's forested area. 3. The FRA cut-off date is the date the Act came into force. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q68. With reference to Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission, consider the following statements: 1. CAMPA is triggered specifically by diversion of forest land for non-forest use and is funded by user-agency payments (Net Present Value plus compensatory-afforestation cost). 2. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 established the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and CAMPA's statutory governance structure. 3. The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q69. With reference to Space Programme, ISRO, Launch Vehicles and Space Governance, consider the following statements: 1. SLV-3 was India's first experimental satellite launch vehicle; ASLV served as an intermediate technology-learning step before PSLV. 2. ISRO's Launchers page lists PSLV, GSLV and LVM3 as active operational launch vehicles. 3. ISRO, NSIL and IN-SPACE are just three names for the same organisation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q70. With reference to Satellites, NavIC, GAGAN and Applications, consider the following statements: 1. NavIC is India's independent regional satellite navigation system; it is not India's name for GPS. 2. ISRO states that NavIC provides two services: Standard Positioning Service (SPS) and Restricted Service (RS). 3. "NavIC has 11 satellites, so it is a large constellation.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q71. With reference to Human Spaceflight, Gaganyaan and Planetary Missions, consider the following statements: 1. ISRO states that Gaganyaan envisages sending a crew of three members to about 400 km orbit for about three days and recovering them in Indian sea waters. 2. ISRO identifies Human Rated LVM3 (HLVM3) as the launcher for Gaganyaan. 3. Approved Bharatiya Antariksh Station or Venus Orbiter plans should be written as completed missions. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q72. With reference to Nuclear Power and the Three-Stage Programme, consider the following statements: 1. Homi Bhabha's three-stage strategy was built around India's limited uranium and large thorium endowment. 2. Stage 1 relies on PHWRs using natural uranium; the resulting spent fuel provides plutonium relevant for later stages. 3. PHWR and PWR are the same because both mention "pressurised water.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q73. With reference to Nuclear Fusion and ITER, consider the following statements: 1. Fusion is different from fission: fusion combines light nuclei, while fission splits heavy nuclei. 2. A tokamak is a magnetic-confinement device; ITER follows the magnetic-confinement route, not inertial confinement. 3. ITER is a power plant that will soon feed electricity to the grid. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q74. With reference to Defence R&D, DRDO and Missile Systems, consider the following statements: 1. DRDO's official site says the organisation was formed in 1958. 2. DRDO's official site says it now works through around 41 laboratories and 05 DRDO Young Scientist Laboratories. 3. A missile and a launch vehicle are the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q75. With reference to Defence Indigenization, Atmanirbhar and Procurement, consider the following statements: 1. The official DDP node shows DAP 2020 as a published government document dated 14 Dec 2020. 2. DAP 2020 broadly classifies capital-acquisition schemes as Buy, Buy and Make, Leasing, Make, Design and Development, and Strategic Partnership Model. 3. "Buy (Indian-IDDM), Buy (Indian) and Buy (Global)" is the complete DAP 'Buy' ladder. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q76. With reference to Digital India and India Stack, UPI, Aadhaar, consider the following statements: 1. UIDAI's official page says UIDAI is a statutory authority established under the Aadhaar Act, 2016, under MeitY. 2. UIDAI's official page says Aadhaar is meant to issue unique IDs to residents and support authenticable identity. 3. Account Aggregator stores and owns customer financial data. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q77. With reference to Artificial Intelligence, Governance and IndiaAI, consider the following statements: 1. The seven pillars, in their current official labels, are IndiaAI Innovation Centre, IndiaAI Application Development Initiative, AIKosh Platform, IndiaAI Compute Capacity, IndiaAI Startup Financing, IndiaAI FutureSkills and Safe & Trusted AI. 2. NITI Aayog authored the National Strategy for AI (#AIforAll, 2018); MeitY/IndiaAI runs the mission. Strategy authorship and mission implementation sit in different institutions. 3. AI, machine learning and generative AI mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q78. With reference to National Quantum Mission and Quantum Tech, consider the following statements: 1. DST's official NQM page says the mission has four Thematic Hubs. 2. The four hubs are for Quantum Computing, Quantum Communication, Quantum Sensing & Metrology, and Quantum Materials & Devices. 3. "Quantum supremacy" means quantum computers are now better than classical ones. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q79. With reference to Multi-Hazard Early Warning and Disaster Technology, consider the following statements: 1. Nowcasting provides ultra-short-term forecasts (5-30 minutes ahead). 2. Doppler radar/hydro-meteorological networks give 3-6 hours' lead time for urban-flood rainfall monitoring. 3. Technology alone (GIS, satellites, apps) is sufficient for effective early warning. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q80. With reference to Earthquake Risk and Resilient Construction, consider the following statements: 1. Earthquake magnitude for large events is commonly reported on the moment magnitude scale (Mw); intensity (observed effects) may be expressed on the Modified Mercalli Intensity (MMI) or MSK scale. 2. India has four seismic zones (II-V) per IS 1893 (Part 1): 2016; Zone V is the highest-hazard zone, covering the whole of North-East India and Andaman & Nicobar, plus

parts of northern Bihar, J&K/Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Gujarat. 3. Richter and Mercalli scales measure the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q81. With reference to Tsunami and Coastal Hazard Management, consider the following statements: 1. India's Tsunami Early Warning System detects tsunamigenic earthquakes in the Indian Ocean in under 10 minutes. 2. The system was established with Department of Space, DST and CSIR. 3. The 2,200 km shoreline and "13 tsunamis in 300 years" figures are current statistics requiring no further check. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q82. With reference to Cyclones, Storm Surge and Coastal Preparedness, consider the following statements: 1. IMD uses four colour codes: Green (no warning), Yellow (be updated), Orange (be prepared), Red (take action). 2. ACWCs are at Kolkata, Chennai and Mumbai; CWCs at Bhubaneswar, Visakhapatnam and Ahmedabad. 3. The colour codes and the cyclone bulletin stages are the same system. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q83. With reference to Riverine Floods and Urban Flood Resilience, consider the following statements: 1. More than 40 million hectares of India's land area is flood-prone (Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment). 2. CWC supplies discharge data; IMD supplies rainfall data, for flood forecasting. 3. The "40 million hectare" flood-prone-area figure and district/state lists are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q84. With reference to Drought, Heat Waves and Slow-Onset Risk, consider the following statements: 1. Four drought types: meteorological, agricultural, hydrological, ecological (Section 2). 2. IMD names five drought situations (Section 2). 3. The 68%-drought-prone and ~820-million-water-scarce figures, and the CWMI's specific state rankings, are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q85. With reference to Landslides, Avalanches and GLOF Risk, consider the following statements: 1. A cloudburst is classified at roughly 10 cm or more rainfall per hour over ~20-30 sq km. 2. Landslides affect at least 15% of India's land area (document-period estimate). 3. The "15% of land area" and vulnerability-zone lists are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q86. With reference to Forest Fire Risk Management, consider the following statements: 1. More than 95% of forest fires are human-caused (negligent or deliberate). 2. India's fire triangle: fuel + oxygen (naturally present) + heat (the initiating factor). 3. The "95% human-caused" and district-concentration percentages are necessarily current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q87. With reference to Industrial, Chemical, Nuclear and CBRN Emergencies, consider the following statements: 1. The Chemical Accident Rules, 1996 established a Central Crisis Group chaired by the Environment Ministry Secretary. 2. The Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991 introduced "no fault liability" and established the Environmental Relief Fund (2008). 3. India's nuclear-power capacity/target figures cited by VisionIAS are current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q88. With reference to Urban and Critical Infrastructure Resilience, consider the following statements: 1. CDRI was launched by India at the UN Climate Action Summit, New York, on 23 September 2019. 2. CDRI has four thematic areas: risk assessment, design/implementation standards, financing mechanisms, reconstruction/recovery. 3. Urban-flood management is solved by drainage redesign alone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q89. With reference to Climate Risk, Adaptation and Loss and Damage, consider the following statements: 1. Slow-onset disasters include climate change, desertification, soil degradation and drought. 2. The Warsaw International Mechanism on Loss and Damage was established at COP19 (2013). 3. Loss-and-damage finance figures can be cited without a specific COP decision/date. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q90. With reference to Disaster Finance, Risk Transfer and Build Back Better, consider the following statements: 1. Four risk-management strategies: acceptance, avoidance, reduction, transfer (insurance being the most common transfer form). 2. SDRF funds immediate State-level relief; the National Disaster Response Fund provides Centre-level assistance beyond SDRF capacity. 3. The Rs 5,690 crore/Rs 2,500 crore NCCD figures are current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q91. With reference to Union Budget 2026-27 dated 1 February 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. 2. The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q92. With reference to Economic Survey 2025-26 dated 29 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. 2. The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q93. With reference to Economic Survey growth assessment dated 29 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. 2. A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q94. With reference to RBI macro-risk assessment dated 5 August 2026, consider the following statements: 1. RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. 2. External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q95. With reference to India's 100th Ramsar site milestone dated 5 June 2026, consider the following statements: 1. India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. 2. Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q96. With reference to Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone dated 31 December 2025, consider the following statements: 1. Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. 2. Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

Q97. With reference to Renewable-capacity addition dated 31 December 2025, consider the following statements: 1. India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. 2. Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only	B. 1 and 3 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q98. With reference to Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex dated 21 June 2026, consider the following statements: 1. PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. 2. An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q99. With reference to India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch dated 13 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. 2. Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 2 only	D. 1, 2 and 3

Q100. With reference to BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement dated 16 May 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. 2. Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only	B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1, 2 and 3	D. 1 and 2 only

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